

Director of Glenmark Pharmaceuticals, No. 9 by sales, says, “With an ecosystem of world-class talent, cutting-edge research, and robust manufacturing capabilities, we are poised to play a pivotal role in shaping the future of healthcare.” Saldanha says the industry needs to work towards fair and transparent regulatory frameworks so that patients worldwide can get affordable, high-quality medicines.

According to the Indian government’s Economic Survey for 2022-23, the domestic pharmaceuticals market is expected to grow to \$130 billion by 2030.

Through the Covid-19 pandemic, India provided vaccines, essential medicines and supplies such as personal protective equipment (PPE) to several nations, supporting the COVAX initiative and using vaccine supplies as a diplomatic tool.

Reddy says the pandemic highlighted the need to promote R&D of crucial technologies and products in diagnostics, vaccines and therapeutics. To do this, academic institutions, international research organisations, and industry must collaborate, says Reddy.

India has to focus on reducing barriers to access and work on easing intellectual property rights and equitable pricing to make essential medicines more affordable and accessible. India must also project its robust regulatory environment, transparency and growth potential to invite substantial international investment into its healthcare and pharmaceuticals sector.

The FDI rush continues: in 2022-23, the FDI inflows into the pharma industry reached \$2 billion, representing a CAGR growth of 67 per cent since 2018-19. In the first 11 months of calendar year 2022, the government had cleared 21 FDI proposals adding up to ₹4,681 crore (\$590 million), mostly for existing projects.

“India’s leadership in generic drugs and vaccine pro-

duction necessitates concerted efforts to maintain its position and ensure high drug quality standards,” says Manoj Saxena, Managing Director of Bayer Zydus Pharma. “We are committed to addressing the priorities of the G20 Health Working Group, which includes prevention, preparedness and response to health emergencies,” says Saxena, also Country Division Head, South Asia for the Pharmaceuticals division of Bayer.

CLEAR DECKS FOR MEDICAL TOURISM

The G20 presidency is also expected to help India’s medical tourism sector. The Indian medical tourism market was valued at \$2.89 billion in 2020 and is projected to reach \$13.42 billion by 2026. According to the India Tourism Statistics at a Glance 2020 report, approximately 697,300 foreign citizens came to India for medical treatment during FY19 to get better care or avoid high costs or long waiting lines in their countries. India ranked 10th out of 46 destinations in the Medical Tourism Index (MTI) for 2020-21, as recognised by the Medical Tourism Association.

Siddhartha Bhattacharya, Secretary General of NatHealth, the healthcare federation of India, says medical tourism not only fetches foreign exchange but also improves the reputation of the destination hospitals. “The year 2023, under the G20 presidency, has the potential to be a landmark moment for healthcare, akin to India’s Y2K milestone in the IT sector back in 2000,” says Bhattacharya.

The Indian government has been investing heavily to improve the healthcare landscape. The Economic Survey 2021-22 says India’s public expenditure on healthcare was 2.1 per cent of gross domestic product (GDP) in 2021-22, compared with 1.8 per cent in



“The G20 brings like-minded people and stakeholders together to discuss potential international collaborations for an effective global healthcare ecosystem”

SATISH REDDY
CHAIRMAN, DR. REDDY’S
LABORATORIES



“With world-class health workers and a thriving consumer tech ecosystem, India is uniquely positioned to become the cradle of global health-tech innovation”

SIDHARTH SRINIVASAN
CEO, LUPIN DIGITAL HEALTH